# Lumi's Nutrition Lab, Books 1–3

*Why this series, what it does, and how it was made*

Story and pictures by **Soyee Lee** (Grade 12, Chadwick International) · Illustrated chapter books in English for ages 6–9 (Grades 1–3) · Fall 2026 · Paperback: Baninoon · Ebook: Kindle/Amazon

**This is not a book that tells children what to eat. It teaches them to notice how their own body responds — and to write it down, like a scientist.**

The series line: ***"My body has its own opinions."***

## 01 Why now *from lifespan to healthspan*

1 **From lifespan to healthspan.** A child born in Korea in 2024 can expect to live 83.7 years, but only 65.5 of them free of illness — about 18 years lived with disease.[1] Healthy aging is designed over a whole life, not managed only in old age.

2 **Prevention starts at the table.** Dietary risks were linked to about 22% of adult deaths worldwide in 2017.[2] Daily eating is one of the biggest everyday factors in healthspan.

3 **Habits start early.** Eating habits formed in childhood tend to carry into adulthood.[3] As the Korean proverb goes, habits formed at three last until eighty.

4 **From the average to the individual.** The same meal raised blood sugar very differently in different adults[4] — even in identical twins.[5] The U.S. NIH now uses data from 10,000 people and AI to predict each person's response to food.[6]

5 **Testing what everyone "knows."** A meta-analysis of 23 double-blind studies found no effect of sugar on children's behavior or thinking.[7] Mothers told their sons had eaten sugar rated them as more hyperactive — though every boy had a placebo.[8] Decide the answer first, and you observe your beliefs, not the body.

*This does not mean sugar is harmless. It means one rule does not fit every child.*

## 02 What the series does *it does not lecture; it teaches children to observe*

- **No rules about food.** Instead of "no chocolate at night," the story shows what can happen — and that it differs from child to child. In Book 2, three friends share one cake at the same hour: Maya falls asleep at 1:45, Theo at 2:00, and Jiwoo not at all.
- **Notice → record → discover.** Every Lab Notes section ends on the same line: *Not every body responds the same way.* "I felt nothing" counts as real data.
- **A lifelong skill.** A scientist's eye on your own body helps extend healthspan, manage aging and shape your body's time — the ground for a more dignified life.
- **Why ages 6–9.** At that age, my mother's advice — less salt, more water, eat your vegetables — sounded like nagging. I wrote the book I wish I had read then.

## 03 Inside each book *same order in Books 1–3*

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 **Jiwoo's story · 8 chapters**<br>*one food, one incident, told by Jiwoo* | 4 **Lumi's Word Lab**<br>*science words, in Lumi's voice* |
| 2 **Lumi's Secret Lab Notes**<br>*how the body works, in drawings and graphs* | 5 **Jiwoo's "Prove It" Tracker**<br>*Jiwoo's filled-in week + a blank log* |
| 3 **Think Like a Scientist**<br>*open questions for a read-aloud discussion* | 6 **For the Grown-Up Lab Partner**<br>*supporting, not grading; safety notes* |

## 04 How it differs *from books that give answers*

| | Typical children's nutrition books | Lumi's Nutrition Lab |
|---|---|---|
| **Food** | Good vs. bad foods — e.g., the "traffic-light" foods of *Eat Healthy, Feel Great* (Sears et al., 2002) | **No food is good or bad. The book asks when, how much and with what — and how the body answered** |
| **Standard** | One answer for everyone ("eight glasses of water a day") | **Individual difference is the core message: same food, different bodies** |
| **Child** | Listens and follows | **Researcher and subject (Case #001–#010)** |
| **Adult** | Teaches and corrects | **A lab partner, not a grader** |
| **Results** | A lesson ("so X is bad") | **"No change" and "I don't know" are praised as honest data** |
| **Activities** | Recipes, posters, quizzes with right answers | **The "Prove It" Tracker: the reader's own data, not answers** |

**Why it matters.** Preschoolers told a food would make them strong ate less of it.[9] Restricting a food made children want — and eat — more of it.[10] Storybooks on how the body uses food raised preschoolers' vegetable eating.[11] The "eight glasses" rule lacks evidence in healthy adults.[12]

## 05 How it was made *children's questions changed the book*

1. **Design.** Jiwoo (9, a soccer player) and Lumi, the Inner-Body Data Collector. The hidden idea: Lumi is Jiwoo grown up — a nutrition scientist who never scolds, only watches and asks questions. One book = one food, one incident; afterwards, readers keep their own log.
2. **Pilot reading, June 2026.** Six second graders at an international school followed the story but kept asking about words like *melatonin* and *sodium* — and the main message got lost.
3. **Revision: stronger back matter.** *Lumi's Word Lab* (terms at a child's level), *Think Like a Scientist* (question → observe → collect data → record) and *For the Grown-Up Lab Partner* (welcome every record; don't judge). From Book 1: "Yours is hearing 'I didn't feel anything' and answering, 'Good.'"

## 06 The ten-book series *body → body patterns → mind → self*

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|---|---|---|
| **Body** Books 1–3 · 2026 | 1 | **The Day I Tried to Run on Pure Sparkles** — sugar and blood sugar |
| | 2 | **The Sleepover Chocolate Disaster** — caffeine and sleep |
| | 3 | **The Bottomless Popcorn Paradox** — salt, water and how a body asks |
| **Body patterns** Books 4–6 | 4 | **The Great Broccoli Standoff** — why the same food tastes different |
| | 5 | **The Beige Food Phase** — variety, fiber and the city inside the gut |
| | 6 | **The Chaos of the Skipped Breakfast** — breakfast and the overnight fast |
| **Mind** Books 7–9 | 7 | **My Stomach Is Bored, Not Hungry** — mouth-hunger vs. tummy-hunger |
| | 8 | **The Pre-Test Tummy Ache** — stress and the brain–belly hotline |
| | 9 | **The Screen-Time Zombie Effect** — screens and eating without noticing |
| **Self** Book 10 | 10 | **The Scientist of My Own Body** — Notice → Wonder → Test → Report |
| | | *Books 4–10 are planned and drafted; responses to Books 1–3 will shape them.* |


**References**

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